

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Landscaping and Grounds English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Landscape crew members, groundskeepers, lawn-service workers, and grounds assistants.

All properties, people, quantities, incidents, and service arrangements are fictional language practice, not horticultural, pesticide, equipment, irrigation, tree-work, safety, or property-law training. Do not infer plant treatments, application rates, pruning methods, site safety, or legal boundaries from these examples. Refer technical suitability, hazardous conditions, property questions, prices, and job changes to the responsible qualified people.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

Open this course on English Ladder

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Confirming the booked grounds work

Clarify an extra task without dismissing the customer's request.

02 Clarifying access and property limits

Decline an unconfirmed extension while preserving the agreed job.

03 Clarifying appearance and plant requests

Establish which plant and which visual concern the customer means.

04 Explaining a weather-related change

Give a useful weather update without making unsupported safety or scheduling judgments.

05 Reporting site observations without diagnosis

Give a specific site report that a qualified colleague can assess.

06 Checking materials and requested quantities

Describe two discrepancies without converting a visual guess into approval.

07 Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

Acknowledge a visible shortfall without accepting unrelated scope changes.

08 Handing over unfinished grounds work

Transfer completed tasks, deferred questions, and customer contact needs accurately.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Confirming the booked grounds work

Clarify an extra task without dismissing the customer's request.

SITUATION

Oak Court's work order includes front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance. Resident asks for rear-hedge shaping. Hedges are excluded from today's booking; office can review a separate request, with no price or date confirmed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

work order - The job record stating the grounds work requested or agreed for a visit.

service area - The specified part of a property included in a grounds job.

exclusion - A task or location expressly left outside the agreed work.

recurring visit - A grounds-service appointment that repeats on an agreed schedule.

Useful word combinations

confirm the work order: compare the customer's request with the job record

define the service area: name the included part of the property

flag an extra request: separate new work from the existing booking

check the recurring schedule: verify which tasks happen on which visits

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Name what the visit includes

3. Notice the language

A recurring service does not automatically include every grounds task on every visit.

Today's work order includes ____.

____ is outside this visit's listed work.

Would you like the office to review ____ separately?

Compare this wording: We do the garden.

Clearer: Today's booking covers the front lawn and path; hedge shaping needs a separate review.

Specific tasks prevent a broad description from becoming an unintended promise.

4. Check the language

1. Resident: Is the hedge part of today's booking?

Worker: No; it is an ____ request.

- A. included
- B. additional
- C. identical
- D. completed

2. Office: Is every recurring visit a hedge visit?

Worker: No, the tasks vary ____ the agreed schedule.

- A. except
- B. despite
- C. according to
- D. instead of

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

The rear hedge is a new request

At Oak Court, a worker checks the resident's expectation against today's work order.

01 • Resident: Could you shape the rear hedge during today's grounds visit?

02 • Worker: Today's work order covers the front lawn and leaf clearance from the path, not hedge shaping.

03 • Resident: I thought our recurring service meant the whole garden was included on every visit.

04 • Worker: The recurring schedule lists particular tasks. I can ask the office to review your hedge request separately.

05 • Resident: Would asking them now guarantee that your crew can finish it during this visit?

06 • Worker: No. The scope, availability, and any price need confirmation before we describe it as booked.

07 • Resident: Please query the rear hedge, not the front shrubs.

08 • Worker: I'll name that location clearly and keep it separate from the work already listed today.

09 • Resident: Thank you. Can the office contact me with the actual options rather than a general estimate?

10 • Worker: I'll request office contact without promising extra work or timing.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The annual task is not every visit

A grounds worker clarifies a customer's seasonal-service expectation.

01 • Customer: Why isn't seasonal bed review listed on this week's work order?

02 • Worker: The agreement covers several visits, but this work order lists lawn care and front-path clearance only.

03 • Customer: Does that mean the seasonal review has been removed from my service agreement altogether?

04 • Worker: I don't have evidence of that. A task absent from today's list isn't necessarily canceled from the agreement.

05 • Customer: Can you check which visit it belongs to so I don't keep asking every crew?

06 • Worker: I can ask the office to confirm its scheduled visit and let you know the current status.

07 • Customer: Please specify front beds; another company handles our rear beds.

08 • Worker: I'll include that limit. We shouldn't combine two different service areas under a vague garden review.

09 • Customer: Then today's crew completes its listed work, while the office confirms the seasonal appointment separately.

10 • Worker: Today's work remains as listed; the office will clarify the seasonal task.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A request from someone who is not the contact

A worker checks a tenant's extra-work request at an office property.

01 • Tenant: Could you add the side courtyard? Our visitors arrive later.

02 • Worker: The work order names the main entrance only. Who coordinates grounds requests for your building?

03 • Tenant: Mara in facilities is the site contact, but I'm the tenant using the courtyard today.

04 • Worker: Thanks. I can relay your request to Mara rather than treat it as a change already approved.

05 • Tenant: Please explain the visitor timing, because otherwise she might think I'm asking about next month.

06 • Worker: I will. What time are visitors expected, and which courtyard entrance are they using?

07 • Tenant: Two o'clock at the east door; the rear parking area is excluded.

08 • Worker: I'll state the side courtyard and east door, with the two-o'clock event as your constraint.

09 • Tenant: That describes it accurately. I understand you can't promise the additional work on your own.

10 • Worker: The main-entrance booking stays unchanged while Mara reviews your courtyard request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Confirming the booked grounds work

Oak Court's work order includes front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance. Resident asks for rear-hedge shaping. Hedges are excluded from today's booking; office can review a separate request, with no price or date confirmed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Resident: you assumed a regular grounds visit included the hedge; ask for a separate review.

Second round: The resident asks whether requesting the extra task guarantees it today. Distinguish request from booking.

Scenario 2 | Two tasks under the word tidy

Work order: clear leaves from front steps. Customer says 'tidy the front' and also means reshape shrubs. Shrub work is not booked.

Role A: Worker: separate cleanup from plant work.

Role B: Customer: ask about both, but accept a separate scope review.

Possible opening: When you say tidy, do you mean the leaves or the shrub shape?

Success checks

- Name the included leaf clearance.
- Describe the shrub request separately.
- Avoid quoting an unconfirmed price.

Add a complication: Customer assumes both tasks have the same price.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying access and property limits

Decline an unconfirmed extension while preserving the agreed job.

SITUATION

Customer asks for clearing beyond a rear fence, saying the strip is probably theirs. Work plan ends at the fence; ownership is unconfirmed. Worker can flag the request to the office but cannot decide the property boundary.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

access arrangement - The agreed way and time for workers to enter a property or service area.

property boundary - The limit separating properties; its legal position requires appropriate confirmation, not a worker's guess.

no-work area - A specifically identified area excluded from work during the job.

site contact - The named person who answers access or job-location questions at a property.

Useful word combinations

confirm access with the site contact: verify entry arrangements

identify the no-work area: name the excluded location

query the boundary: ask for confirmation rather than infer ownership

preserve the agreed limit: keep work within the confirmed scope

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Keep uncertain boundaries explicit

3. Notice the language

A fence, hedge, or informal statement may not establish the legal property limit. Practice referral, not boundary advice.

Our confirmed work area ends at ____.

The status of ____ hasn't been established.

We can refer ____ while continuing with ____.

Compare this wording: It's close enough to yours.

Clearer: The plan ends at the fence; the extra strip needs confirmation before inclusion.

The response does not make an ownership judgment.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Does the fence prove the legal boundary?

Worker: No; it shows our current work ____, not a legal conclusion.

A. limit

B. estimate

C. schedule

D. finish standard

2. Office: Has the strip beyond the fence been confirmed as included?

Worker: No; it is ____.

A. awaiting inclusion confirmation

B. already inside the work order

C. excluded from every future visit

D. part of every recurring visit

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Beyond the rear fence

A grounds worker responds to an uncertain property-area request.

01 • Customer: Could you clear beyond the fence? I think that strip is ours.

02 • Worker: The confirmed work plan ends at the fence. The extra strip isn't included in today's area.

03 • Customer: But the previous owner used it. Doesn't that make it reasonable to include while you're here?

04 • Worker: I can't establish the property boundary from that history. The office needs to review the request.

05 • Customer: Then you're not saying it belongs to someone else; you're saying it hasn't been confirmed?

06 • Worker: Exactly. I'm describing the limit of this job, not making a legal ownership decision.

07 • Customer: Can your team continue within the confirmed area while I contact the office?

08 • Worker: Yes, subject to the lead's site decisions. I'll keep the extra-area request separate in the handoff.

09 • Customer: Please call it the strip beyond the rear fence, not the whole back garden.

10 • Worker: I'll identify the strip without changing today's confirmed work boundary.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A locked gate is an access issue

A worker calls the named site contact about a closed service entrance.

01 • Worker: The agreed courtyard service gate is locked; we've arrived for the visit.

02 • Site contact: I thought reception had arranged access. Have you spoken with anyone who can confirm today's entry arrangement?

03 • Worker: Reception said they weren't given the booking. I haven't treated another entrance as approved access.

04 • Site contact: I can coordinate with the building team. Please keep the issue described as access unconfirmed, not customer cancellation.

05 • Worker: Understood. The scheduled work still exists; we can't yet reach the agreed service area.

06 • Site contact: The building contact will call you in ten minutes with a confirmed arrangement or a status update.

07 • Worker: Ten minutes means an update, not guaranteed access, correct?

08 • Site contact: Yes. I don't want you planning around an opening time the building team hasn't confirmed.

09 • Worker: I'll tell the lead the access check is underway and keep the rest of the visit status accurate.

10 • Site contact: I'll give reception the courtyard work-order reference when checking access.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A marked no-work area

A worker confirms an excluded flower bed with a facilities contact.

01 • Worker: The bed beside the west bench is marked as a no-work area today.

02 • Facilities contact: That's correct. Another team is reviewing it, and this grounds visit should exclude that particular bed.

03 • Worker: A resident asked us to include it because the rest of the courtyard is being serviced.

04 • Facilities contact: Please explain that the bed has a specific exclusion, not that the entire courtyard visit is canceled.

05 • Worker: Should I refer their question to you rather than try to explain the other team's technical work?

06 • Facilities contact: Yes. You can identify me as the site contact for that request without guessing what their review involves.

07 • Worker: West-bench bed, not the east entrance bed; is that correct?

08 • Facilities contact: Exactly. Those two locations are easy to confuse when people just say the bench area.

09 • Worker: The crew's handoff will preserve that named exclusion while showing the other listed areas unchanged.

10 • Facilities contact: I'll explain the separate review requirement to the resident.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying access and property limits

Customer asks for clearing beyond a rear fence, saying the strip is probably theirs. Work plan ends at the fence; ownership is unconfirmed. Worker can flag the request to the office but cannot decide the property boundary.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: you believe the strip is yours but have no confirmed job-area amendment.

Second round: A neighbor offers permission verbally. Keep ownership and job authorization questions with the responsible office.

Scenario 2 | Permission for access, not extra work

Building contact authorizes access through a side gate to reach the booked rear lawn. A resident assumes this adds side-bed work; it does not.

Role A: Worker: distinguish route of access from service area.

Role B: Resident: request side-bed work separately.

Possible opening: Does using the side gate change which beds are included?

Success checks

- Confirm the access arrangement.
- Keep rear lawn as booked.
- Refer side-bed work as an extra request.

Add a complication: Resident points to the gate permission as proof of added scope.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Clarifying appearance and plant requests

Establish which plant and which visual concern the customer means.

SITUATION

Customer says 'tidy the tall one' beside two plants near the entrance. They mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed, not the specimen magnolia. A qualified lead must review whether and how any pruning fits the job.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

hedge line - The visible outline or agreed shape of a row of closely grown shrubs.

flower bed - A defined planting area intended for flowers or other ornamental plants.

specimen plant - An individual plant treated as a distinctive feature of the landscape.

pruning request - A customer's proposed change to plant growth or shape that requires suitability and scope review.

Useful word combinations

describe the desired appearance: explain the visual result being requested

identify the specimen plant: distinguish the individual plant concerned

confirm which bed: use a location rather than a vague direction

refer a pruning request: ask the qualified lead to review suitability

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Replace vague appearance words with a clear request

3. Notice the language

Clarifying a preference is not diagnosing plant health or prescribing pruning.

Which plant do you mean by ___?

Are you asking about ___ or ___?

I'll relay the desired appearance for ___ to review.

Compare this wording: We'll tidy that one.

Clearer: Do you mean the rosemary by the left bed, rather than the magnolia by the door?

Explicit location and identity avoid an ambiguous gesture.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: I mean the rosemary, not the magnolia.

Worker: Thank you for ___ which plant.

- A. clear
- B. clarified
- C. clarifying
- D. clarity

2. Lead: Has the pruning method been agreed?

Worker: No; we clarified the customer's ___ only.

- A. method
- B. authorization
- C. diagnosis
- D. preference

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Which tall plant?

A worker clarifies an appearance request beside the entrance.

01 • Customer: Could someone tidy the tall plant? Its outline looks uneven.

02 • Worker: Do you mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed or the magnolia near the door?

03 • Customer: The rosemary. Please leave the magnolia out of this request; it's our specimen plant.

04 • Worker: Thanks. What part of the appearance concerns you so I can relay the request accurately?

05 • Customer: It looks uneven from the path. Could your lead take a look?

06 • Worker: I'll relay that pruning request to the lead for a suitability and scope review.

07 • Customer: Would reshaping it guarantee more flowers as well?

08 • Worker: I can't promise that outcome. The lead can discuss the plant question with you separately.

09 • Customer: Yes, the rosemary beside the left bed. Please leave the magnolia alone.

10 • Worker: I'll relay that specific appearance request without treating it as a pruning instruction.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A photo shows a preference, not a method

A grounds worker discusses a reference image with a customer.

01 • Customer: Could our entrance hedge resemble the outline in this photograph?

02 • Worker: The photograph helps show your preference, but I can't promise the same result for a different hedge.

03 • Customer: I mainly like the even outline. I don't know whether the plants are the same type.

04 • Worker: Then I'll describe the desired outline and leave plant suitability and any method to the lead.

05 • Customer: Please don't tell the lead I requested removing half of it. That's not what I meant.

06 • Worker: I won't convert a visual example into an invented amount of work or a cutting instruction.

07 • Customer: Please preserve the entrance view; don't include the side hedge.

08 • Worker: Yes. I'll identify the entrance hedge as the subject and the side hedge as outside this request.

09 • Customer: That gives the lead enough context to discuss options with me rather than copy the photo blindly.

10 • Worker: The photograph expresses a preference; actual work still needs review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The bed name changed in the customer's description

A worker and customer establish which planting area a request concerns.

01 • Worker: Your message says kitchen bed; our plan uses compass directions.

02 • Customer: I mean the narrow bed outside the kitchen window, which faces the courtyard on the south side.

03 • Worker: Then is that the south courtyard bed, rather than the large bed beside the south gate?

04 • Customer: Yes. Both face south, but only the narrow one is directly under the kitchen window.

05 • Worker: Could you describe the appearance concern without naming a treatment you aren't certain about?

06 • Customer: The plants look uneven in height. I'd like the lead to discuss a more consistent appearance.

07 • Worker: I'll specify the narrow bed under the kitchen window, not the gate bed.

08 • Customer: Please also say the container by the door is separate and should stay out of the request.

09 • Worker: I have both limits. No plant method or replacement choice has been agreed during this clarification.

10 • Customer: Correct. We're clarifying the area and appearance, not choosing a method.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Clarifying appearance and plant requests

Customer says 'tidy the tall one' beside two plants near the entrance. They mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed, not the specimen magnolia. A qualified lead must review whether and how any pruning fits the job.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: identify the rosemary and say its outline looks uneven; do not invent a method.

Second round: The customer asks for a guarantee the plant will flower more. Refer that outcome question to the qualified lead.

Scenario 2 | Keeping a focal plant distinct

Customer asks about the low shrubs beside a fountain. The central specimen plant is excluded. Customer describes the desired appearance as 'less crowded'; no method is agreed.

Role A: Worker: clarify which plants and the visual concern.

Role B: Customer: preserve the central specimen and refer methods to the lead.

Possible opening: Does less crowded refer to the surrounding shrubs or the central plant?

Success checks

- Identify surrounding shrubs only.
- Preserve the specimen exclusion.
- Do not turn a preference into a removal instruction.

Add a complication: A coworker interprets the phrase as a definite removal request.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Explaining a weather-related change

Give a useful weather update without making unsupported safety or scheduling judgments.

SITUATION

Lead has paused Cedar Court's planned outdoor work because of site conditions after rain. Office suggests Thursday, but crew availability is unconfirmed. Customer has an event Friday. Worker can relay the event and request a scheduling update by Wednesday noon.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

weather delay - A change in planned grounds work caused by weather conditions affecting the job.

rescheduled visit - A replacement appointment confirmed after the original visit changes.

service interval - The time between successive grounds-service visits.

provisional date - A suggested date that has not yet become a confirmed appointment.

Useful word combinations

report a weather delay: explain the changed visit status

offer a provisional date: identify a possible time without confirming it

review the service interval: check the gap created by a delay

confirm the revised visit: state the actual agreed replacement booking

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Explain what is paused and what is provisional

3. Notice the language

Relay the lead's decision and the actual booking status. Avoid declaring a site suitable yourself.

The lead has paused ___ because ___.

___ is provisional until ___ confirms it.

Your event is ___; I'll request an update by ___.

Compare this wording: We'll definitely be back Thursday.

Clearer: Thursday is proposed; the office still needs to confirm crew availability.

The revision prevents a suggestion from becoming a guarantee.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Is Thursday definitely booked?

Worker: No, it is still ____.

- A. canceled
- B. overdue
- C. completed
- D. provisional

2. Office: Is Wednesday noon the finish time?

Worker: No, it is the requested ____ time.

- A. inspection
- B. arrival
- C. completion
- D. update

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Thursday remains provisional

A worker updates Cedar Court's customer about a paused visit.

01 • Worker: The lead paused today's outdoor work because of post-rain site conditions.

02 • Customer: The office mentioned Thursday. My event is Friday, so can I count on everything being finished beforehand?

03 • Worker: Thursday is a provisional date; crew availability and completion before your event remain unconfirmed.

04 • Customer: Please tell the office the front entrance matters most to us for Friday's visitors.

05 • Worker: I'll relay that priority as your request, not as a change already approved by the crew.

06 • Customer: Could someone give me an update by Wednesday noon even if the date remains uncertain?

07 • Worker: I'll request Wednesday noon's update, explaining your Friday event constraint.

08 • Customer: Then Wednesday noon is the update request, and Thursday is still only a suggested visit?

09 • Worker: Exactly. The office needs to confirm an actual replacement arrangement before we treat it as booked.

10 • Customer: Thanks. I'll keep Thursday provisional when discussing arrangements with our event team.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A visit moved, not removed

A worker clarifies a weather message with a customer.

01 • Customer: Does postponed mean this month's service has been canceled?

02 • Worker: No. It means the scheduled visit has been delayed; the replacement date is still being arranged.

03 • Customer: I was concerned we'd skip straight to next month and lose the work that was due.

04 • Worker: I can pass that concern to scheduling and ask how the delay affects the service interval.

05 • Customer: Please don't promise an extra visit unless the office has actually agreed one for our property.

06 • Worker: I won't. I'll ask for the revised arrangement rather than infer it from the word postponed.

07 • Customer: Is Tuesday confirmed, or merely a provisional replacement date?

08 • Worker: The note labels Tuesday provisional. The office still needs to confirm the crew and timing.

09 • Customer: Then please have them state the new date clearly when it is settled, not just send 'rescheduled.'

10 • Worker: I'll request a clear replacement date once scheduling actually confirms it.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Only one part of the visit changed

A worker explains a limited change to a facilities contact.

01 • Worker: The rear-lawn task is deferred; today's entrance-area review remains planned.

02 • Facilities contact: I heard weather delay and assumed the entire visit was canceled, including that review.

03 • Worker: The message was too broad. The change applies to the rear-lawn task, not every listed activity.

04 • Facilities contact: Thank you for correcting it. Has the lead confirmed the remaining plan under today's site conditions?

05 • Worker: Yes, that remaining review is confirmed by the lead. I am relaying the decision, not assessing conditions myself.

06 • Facilities contact: Then the completion note should show which task was deferred and which review actually took place.

07 • Worker: The rear-lawn follow-up still needs scheduling; no replacement date is confirmed.

08 • Facilities contact: Please send that question to the office rather than describing our next regular visit as the replacement automatically.

09 • Worker: I'll do that. The postponed task and the regular schedule will remain separate until scheduling confirms the arrangement.

10 • Facilities contact: That preserves today's remaining review and the separate deferred lawn task.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Explaining a weather-related change

Lead has paused Cedar Court's planned outdoor work because of site conditions after rain. Office suggests Thursday, but crew availability is unconfirmed. Customer has an event Friday. Worker can relay the event and request a scheduling update by Wednesday noon.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: Friday's event matters; ask for a clear update rather than a guarantee.

Second round: Thursday becomes unavailable. Explain the change and ask the office for actual alternatives instead of defending the earlier suggestion.

Scenario 2 | The proposed date conflicts with access

Office proposes Monday after a weather delay. Property contact says gate access is unavailable Monday but confirmed Tuesday morning; crew availability Tuesday is unknown.

Role A: Worker: pass on the access constraint.

Role B: Customer: offer Tuesday access, not a crew booking.

Possible opening: Is Tuesday confirmed for access only, or for the crew as well?

Success checks

- Separate access from crew availability.
- Keep Monday unsuitable for this access arrangement.
- Ask the office to confirm an actual replacement visit.

Add a complication: Customer tells a neighbor the crew is booked Tuesday.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Reporting site observations without diagnosis

Give a specific site report that a qualified colleague can assess.

SITUATION

Worker sees standing water beside the east bed near irrigation zone 3 at 09:15. Cause is unknown; no system check has occurred. Customer asks if a pipe is broken. Grounds lead can arrange review.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

irrigation zone - A defined section served by a particular part of an irrigation system.

standing water - Water remaining visibly pooled on a surface.

bare patch - An area of lawn or planting bed where expected growth is absent.

site observation - A factual description of something noticed at the property, with location and time.

Useful word combinations

report standing water: describe visible pooling and location

identify the affected zone: name the recorded irrigation area

separate observation from cause: avoid diagnosing an unconfirmed fault

refer a plant-health concern: pass an issue to a qualified person

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Describe a symptom without naming a cause

3. Notice the language

Location and timing make an observation useful. Do not turn a visible condition into technical diagnosis.

I noticed ___ at ___ near ___.

I haven't established whether ___.

Could the lead review ___?

Compare this wording: The pipe is broken.

Clearer: Water is pooled by the east bed; the cause has not been checked.

The statement stays within observed facts.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Does the pooling prove a pipe is leaking?

Worker: No. My report gives ___, with the cause unconfirmed.

A. a site observation

B. a pipe-failure diagnosis

C. an approved irrigation repair

D. a completed system check

2. Lead: The neighbor says it pools after rain. Have you verified that history?

Worker: No; it is ___.

A. the neighbor's reported experience

B. my verified seasonal record

C. a confirmed irrigation fault

D. an agreed repair instruction

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Water near zone three

A worker reports a site observation to a customer.

01 • Worker: At 09:15, I saw standing water beside the east bed, near irrigation zone three.

02 • Customer: Does that mean an underground pipe is broken, or could the recent rain explain it?

03 • Worker: I haven't checked the irrigation system, so I can't confirm either explanation from this observation.

04 • Customer: Then please tell the grounds lead exactly where you saw it and when it was visible.

05 • Worker: I'll report the east bed, zone three, and nine fifteen, with the cause explicitly unconfirmed.

06 • Customer: Our neighbor says that area always pools after rain. Should you include what they said?

07 • Worker: Yes. I'll note that your neighbor reports pooling after rain, but I haven't verified that history.

08 • Customer: That sounds fair. I don't want a note saying we've already diagnosed a pipe problem.

09 • Worker: I'll keep the visible pooling separate from the possible causes and request the lead's review.

10 • Customer: Please identify the review contact without promising a repair outcome.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A bare patch does not identify a treatment

A customer asks a grounds worker about a lawn observation.

01 • Customer: Which treatment would fix this bare patch beside the walkway?

02 • Worker: I can report the patch and its location, but I can't diagnose its cause or prescribe a treatment.

03 • Customer: It seems larger than last week, although I didn't measure it or take a dated photograph.

04 • Worker: I'll describe that as your impression of change, alongside what is visible during today's visit.

05 • Customer: Please don't write that it doubled in size. I don't have evidence for an exact amount.

06 • Worker: I won't. The report will distinguish your observation over time from a measured comparison we haven't made.

07 • Customer: Who can review the plant-health concern and identify useful assessment information?

08 • Worker: The qualified grounds lead can take that question and discuss an appropriate review with you.

09 • Customer: Then the immediate result is a clear report, not an assumption that you have started a treatment.

10 • Worker: I'll relay today's observation and your qualified account of the change.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

An observation was assigned to the wrong bed

A worker corrects a site-report location with the grounds lead.

01 • Worker: My yellowing-leaf report named the north bed; I meant east.

02 • Grounds lead: Thanks for catching that. Does the correction change only the location, or also what you observed?

03 • Worker: Only the location. I saw yellowing on several leaves; I haven't identified a disease or cause.

04 • Grounds lead: Then please preserve the observation and correct the bed name without adding a diagnosis to the note.

05 • Worker: The east bed is beside the reception window, not the planting area by the north gate.

06 • Grounds lead: That landmark helps. I'll use it when arranging the review so the right area is assessed.

07 • Worker: Should I notify the office, which received my incorrect location earlier?

08 • Grounds lead: Yes. Updating the note alone doesn't establish that everyone who read the earlier version has seen the correction.

09 • Worker: I'll contact the office with the corrected location and say the cause remains unconfirmed.

10 • Grounds lead: Yes. That corrects the location without making an unsupported plant-health diagnosis.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reporting site observations without diagnosis

Worker sees standing water beside the east bed near irrigation zone 3 at 09:15. Cause is unknown; no system check has occurred. Customer asks if a pipe is broken. Grounds lead can arrange review.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: ask about the pooled water but accept that a qualified review is needed.

Second round: A neighbor says it always happens after rain. Attribute that report without treating it as a verified cause.

Scenario 2 | A damp path reported by someone else

Reception reports dampness near the west path at 08:00. Worker arrives at 10:00 and does not see it. No cause or safety assessment is established.

Role A: Worker: distinguish a reported earlier condition from your present observation.

Role B: Receptionist: confirm time and location, not cause.

Possible opening: Was the dampness present when you saw it at eight, or are you describing it now?

Success checks

- Attribute the 08:00 report.
- State what was observed at 10:00.
- Refer review without declaring the path safe or diagnosing cause.

Add a complication: Someone summarizes the path as always wet.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Checking materials and requested quantities

Describe two discrepancies without converting a visual guess into approval.

SITUATION

A job lists eight bags of dark mulch for the front beds. Delivery has six bags; the label describes natural brown. Customer's approved sample was dark. Worker cannot approve substitution or promise coverage; office will query supplier.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

mulch - Material used as a surface layer over soil in landscape beds; suitability and application require qualified guidance.

delivery quantity - The amount of landscaping material recorded as arriving for a job, with its unit stated.

material sample - A small example used to show a proposed material's appearance or type.

coverage area - The measured or specified surface area intended to receive a material.

Useful word combinations

compare the material sample: check appearance against the agreed example

confirm the delivery quantity: state count and unit

flag a color difference: report a mismatch without approving substitution

check the coverage area: clarify which beds the estimate includes

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Keep quantity and material mismatches separate

3. Notice the language

A bag count does not establish coverage, and a similar-looking material is not automatically the agreed material.

The order lists ____; the delivery has ____.

The sample is ____, while the label says ____.

Please check both ____ and ____.

Compare this wording: It's almost the same delivery.

Clearer: Six natural-brown bags arrived against eight dark bags ordered.

The wording names both differences.

4. Check the language

1. Office: Six bags arrived instead of eight. Is quantity the only mismatch?

Worker: No; the ____ also differs from the approved sample.

A. material description

B. delivery count

C. bag total

D. number of packages

2. Customer: Do six bags prove enough coverage?

Worker: No, the bag count alone doesn't ____ that.

A. mention

B. establish

C. prefer

D. request

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Six bags in a different color

A worker discusses a material discrepancy with the office.

01 • Worker: Eight dark-mulch bags were ordered; six natural-brown bags arrived.

02 • Office clerk: Does the material match the approved sample, or is the quantity the only difference?

03 • Worker: The labels say natural brown, while the customer's approved material sample was described as dark.

04 • Office clerk: Then we need to query both quantity and material description before saying the delivery matches.

05 • Worker: I haven't approved a substitute or told the customer that six bags cover the intended area.

06 • Office clerk: Good. A bag count alone doesn't establish the coverage area or the appropriate application for this job.

07 • Worker: Please query the front-bed work order; rear beds are excluded.

08 • Office clerk: I'll compare that order with the sample record and ask about the two missing bags separately.

09 • Worker: What should I tell the customer while those two discrepancies remain under review?

10 • Office clerk: Report both differences, with no substitute approved while the review remains open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The sample is not the entire delivery

A customer asks a worker about materials arriving for review.

01 • Customer: One small bag arrived; wasn't material ordered for both beds?

02 • Worker: This is labeled material sample for review, not the full delivery quantity for the job.

03 • Customer: I see. I mistook its arrival for the main delivery because both messages mentioned the same work order.

04 • Worker: The shared reference links it to your job, but the shipment description identifies its purpose as a sample.

05 • Customer: Then approving its appearance wouldn't by itself confirm how much material the beds require?

06 • Worker: Correct. The quantity and coverage area still need their own confirmation from the responsible lead and office.

07 • Customer: I'd like to compare both samples before choosing the material.

08 • Worker: I'll pass that preference on and keep the material choice described as pending your review.

09 • Customer: Please don't schedule work just because the sample arrived at the property today.

10 • Worker: I'll clarify: sample received, choice pending, main delivery and work timing unconfirmed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Front beds, not the whole garden

A worker clarifies the area covered by a material estimate.

01 • Worker: The estimate covers two front beds; your message says whole garden.

02 • Customer: I used garden loosely. I meant the front beds beside the path, not the rear lawn.

03 • Worker: Thanks. Does that include the small bed around the entrance sign, or only the two long beds?

04 • Customer: Only the two long beds. The sign bed has separate planting that we don't want included.

05 • Worker: Then I'll keep the coverage area limited to those two front beds when the office checks the quantity.

06 • Customer: Please do. I don't want a larger material order based on an imprecise description in my message.

07 • Worker: Has the office confirmed a quantity, or are we clarifying the area?

08 • Customer: We're clarifying the area. I haven't approved any revised quantity or additional charge.

09 • Worker: I'll report that distinction so the area clarification isn't mistaken for an approved change to the order.

10 • Customer: Exactly. Confirm the area before discussing the required delivery quantity.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Checking materials and requested quantities

A job lists eight bags of dark mulch for the front beds. Delivery has six bags; the label describes natural brown. Customer's approved sample was dark. Worker cannot approve substitution or promise coverage; office will query supplier.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: your sample was dark; you want the front beds only, not the rear beds.

Second round: The supplier calls brown 'close enough.' Keep the substitution decision with the responsible office and customer.

Scenario 2 | Delivery units changed between messages

Office order lists twelve bags. Supplier message says three bundles of four bags. Worker has confirmed three outer bundles, not opened contents.

Role A: Worker: clarify units and verification limits.

Role B: Office clerk: request the packing breakdown before calling it short.

Possible opening: Are those three bundles or three individual bags?

Success checks

- Explain the listed three-by-four relationship.
- Confirm only observed bundles.
- Keep inner bag count unverified until checked.

Add a complication: Customer thinks three means nine bags are missing.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

Acknowledge a visible shortfall without accepting unrelated scope changes.

SITUATION

Customer says path cleanup was incomplete after today's front-lawn visit. Worker can see clippings beside the front steps, within the listed cleanup area. Rear patio is excluded. Lead can organize the missed front cleanup; no wider task is agreed.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

finish standard - The agreed description of how the completed grounds work should look or be left.

clippings - Cut pieces of grass or other vegetation produced during grounds maintenance.

debris removal - The collection and removal of specified loose waste material from the job area.

walk-through - A joint review of the worked area to check completion against the agreed tasks.

Useful word combinations

acknowledge a missed area: recognize a specific unfinished part

compare with the finish standard: check the result against the agreement

arrange a walk-through: review the actual area together

clarify debris removal: distinguish included cleanup from additional waste

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Own the specific omission

3. Notice the language

An apology can name the actual missed work. It need not imply that every requested extra was included.

You're right that ___ remains within the listed area.

I'm sorry ___ was missed.

I'll confirm how ___ will be completed.

Compare this wording: We cleaned everything.

Clearer: The front-step area still has clippings; that part of the listed cleanup was missed.

The response acknowledges the customer's supported observation.

4. Check the language

1. Customer: Are the front steps an extra?

Worker: No; that cleanup was already ____.

- A. excluded
- B. included
- C. unrelated
- D. provisional

2. Lead: Does this include the rear patio now?

Worker: No, that remains a ____ request.

- A. duplicate
- B. withdrawn
- C. separate
- D. completed

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Clippings beside the front steps

A customer and worker review a missed part of the cleanup.

01 • Customer: Clippings remain at the front steps. Wasn't path cleanup included?

02 • Worker: You're right. That location is within the listed cleanup area, and I can see the clippings.

03 • Customer: Thank you for acknowledging it. I also wondered whether the rear patio should have been cleared.

04 • Worker: The rear patio is excluded from this visit. Let's separate that request from the missed front-step cleanup.

05 • Customer: I agree the front steps were already included. Who can arrange for that part to be completed?

06 • Worker: I'll ask the lead to organize it and confirm the plan, rather than invent a return time.

07 • Customer: Could we request a front-area walk-through with the lead?

08 • Worker: I'll relay that request. It will help compare the actual result with the agreed finish standard.

09 • Customer: Please preserve both points: missed front cleanup and a separate question about the rear patio.

10 • Worker: I'll preserve both issues, and I'm sorry the included cleanup was incomplete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Debris from another contractor

A customer asks a grounds worker about a pile beside the job area.

- 01 • Customer:** Does today's debris removal cover that pile beside the entrance?
- 02 • Worker:** The work order includes clippings from our grounds tasks. Do you know where that separate pile came from?
- 03 • Customer:** The paving contractor left it, but I assumed all outdoor waste would be included in your cleanup.
- 04 • Worker:** I understand the assumption. Our listed removal doesn't identify that contractor's material, so the office needs to review it.
- 05 • Customer:** Please don't describe the pile as your crew's missed cleanup if it wasn't generated by your work.
- 06 • Worker:** I won't. I'll name it as a separate waste-removal request and pass on the source you reported.
- 07 • Customer:** Can your team handle that material, or does it need review?
- 08 • Worker:** That needs review by the lead. I can't identify or approve handling from this conversation alone.
- 09 • Customer:** Then keep today's grounds cleanup separate while the office checks this additional request.
- 10 • Worker:** I'll relay the separate request without promising handling, removal, or pricing.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Finished on one side, not both

A worker corrects an overbroad completion statement during a walk-through.

01 • Worker: I called the path finished, but its east edge remains uncleared.

02 • Customer: Yes, the west edge looks complete. I don't want the whole area described as untouched either.

03 • Worker: That's fair. I'll correct my statement to west edge complete, east edge still needing the listed clearance.

04 • Customer: Does that change the work order, or is it simply completing what was already agreed?

05 • Worker: It's the existing task, not a new request. The lead needs to confirm the completion arrangement.

06 • Customer: Please make sure the next person knows exactly which edge remains, so they don't repeat the completed part.

07 • Worker: I'll name the east edge beside the noticeboard, preserving the west as complete.

08 • Customer: That landmark is useful. 'The other side' could mean different things depending on where someone stands.

09 • Worker: I'll name that landmark and correct my premature statement that everything was finished.

10 • Customer: That gives us a precise finish check and a clear outstanding item.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

Customer says path cleanup was incomplete after today's front-lawn visit. Worker can see clippings beside the front steps, within the listed cleanup area. Rear patio is excluded. Lead can organize the missed front cleanup; no wider task is agreed.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Customer: point out clippings at the front steps and also ask about the rear patio.

Second round: The customer says an apology means all cleanup is free. Do not invent prices or decide the separate request.

Scenario 2 | A bin left outside the requested area

Work order includes collecting leaf bags from the front path. Bags are collected, but one empty customer bin remains by the steps instead of its agreed side-store location.

Role A: Worker: acknowledge the specific incomplete finish detail.

Role B: Customer: request correction, not a wider cleanup.

Possible opening: The bags are collected; is the remaining concern the bin's agreed location?

Success checks

- Distinguish completed bag collection from bin-location issue.
- Name the agreed side-store location.
- Ask the lead to arrange the correction.

Add a complication: A colleague marks the whole visit failed.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Handing over unfinished grounds work

Transfer completed tasks, deferred questions, and customer contact needs accurately.

SITUATION

At Pine Court, front-path leaves are cleared. Rear-bed review was deferred by the lead; no planting or diagnosis was done. Customer requests a callback about that bed before Friday. Office contact Ava owns scheduling; a visit date is not booked.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

completion note - A job record distinguishing completed grounds tasks from any stated exceptions.

follow-up visit - A later appointment to review or complete specifically identified work.

seasonal task - A grounds task scheduled for a particular season or period, subject to the job plan.

outstanding item - A task or decision still unresolved at the end of the current visit.

Useful word combinations

separate completed from deferred: name each task's real status

hand over the customer request: preserve its exact scope

confirm the follow-up owner: identify who arranges the next response

close out the visit: report the actual completed work and exceptions

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Close a visit without closing unresolved work

3. Notice the language

A completion note can close today's visit while retaining an outstanding follow-up.

___ is complete; ___ remains deferred.

The customer requests ___ before ___.

___ owns the callback; the visit date is ___.

Compare this wording: Pine Court is finished.

Clearer: The front path is complete; the rear-bed review and callback remain outstanding.

The distinction prevents unfinished work being lost.

4. Check the language

1. Office: Did deferred mean the customer canceled it?

Worker: No, it means the review was ____.

A. diagnosed

B. replaced

C. completed

D. postponed

2. Customer: Is the callback a return appointment?

Worker: No; a callback arranges ____, not automatically a site visit.

A. contact

B. completion

C. approval

D. assessment

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Front path complete, rear-bed review deferred

A worker hands Pine Court's unresolved request to office contact Ava.

01 • Worker: Ava, Pine Court's front-path clearance is complete; rear-bed review remains deferred.

02 • Office clerk: Was any planting or plant diagnosis carried out there, or should those remain unconfirmed?

03 • Worker: Neither was done. The customer requests a callback about that bed before Friday, not a confirmed return date.

04 • Office clerk: I'll take scheduling follow-up. Has a specific callback time already been agreed with the customer?

05 • Worker: No. Please confirm the contact arrangement with them rather than treating before Friday as a booked visit.

06 • Office clerk: Understood. I'll record the callback request separately from the outstanding site review.

07 • Worker: Please retain the front-path completion so the next crew doesn't repeat it.

08 • Office clerk: Yes. The completion note will retain both the finished task and the deferred item.

09 • Worker: Please acknowledge you're the follow-up owner so the customer's question doesn't remain with today's departing crew.

10 • Office clerk: I'll own the callback arrangement; the rear-bed follow-up visit remains unbooked.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A seasonal request in the wrong month

A worker and office clerk clarify a customer's future request.

01 • Worker: The autumn inquiry was mistakenly recorded as this week's unfinished work.

02 • Office clerk: Did the customer request work now, or information about the seasonal schedule later in the year?

03 • Worker: They asked when autumn visits could be discussed. No current appointment or additional work was requested.

04 • Office clerk: Then the note needs to identify a future scheduling inquiry, not unfinished work from today's visit.

05 • Worker: Exactly. Today's listed tasks are complete, and I don't want the next crew sent back for an unbooked task.

06 • Office clerk: Who should contact the customer about seasonal options, and is there an agreed response deadline?

07 • Worker: The office owns the inquiry; no response deadline was agreed.

08 • Office clerk: I'll correct the classification and place the inquiry with scheduling rather than today's completion follow-up.

09 • Worker: Please keep the customer's wording about autumn so the time period doesn't disappear in the shorter note.

10 • Office clerk: I'll retain autumn in the inquiry while keeping today's work complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The next crew needs the customer's exact limit

A departing worker hands a customer preference to an incoming colleague.

01 • Departing worker: The entrance-sign bed is excluded from the next confirmed visit.

02 • Incoming worker: Does that exclusion apply to all front planting, or only the bed around the entrance sign?

03 • Departing worker: Only the sign bed. The two long front beds remain on the next work order.

04 • Incoming worker: Thanks. If the handoff just says avoid the front bed, I'd have several possible interpretations.

05 • Departing worker: I'll use the sign as the landmark and the work-order wording for the other two beds.

06 • Incoming worker: Has the office updated the next booking, or are we passing on an unconfirmed customer preference?

07 • Departing worker: The office already confirmed that exclusion; this handoff highlights the booking.

08 • Incoming worker: Then I can check the same record rather than rely solely on an informal message from the previous crew.

09 • Departing worker: Exactly. No new planting method or material choice was agreed in that customer conversation.

10 • Incoming worker: I'll preserve the sign-bed exclusion and the two included front beds.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Handing over unfinished grounds work

At Pine Court, front-path leaves are cleared. Rear-bed review was deferred by the lead; no planting or diagnosis was done. Customer requests a callback about that bed before Friday. Office contact Ava owns scheduling; a visit date is not booked.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Ava at the office: accept scheduling follow-up; keep the callback request separate from a visit booking.

Second round: The next crew sees 'visit complete.' Explain which task is complete and what the office still owns.

Scenario 2 | An unanswered question at a completed visit

Today's mowing and path clearance are complete. Customer asked about replacing a shrub, but the lead has not reviewed it. Office contact Ben accepts the query.

Role A: Worker: distinguish completed work from the new plant request.

Role B: Ben: take the query; do not book replacement before review.

Possible opening: Does the completion note show the shrub question as a request, not an agreed replacement?

Success checks

- Correct the unsupported replacement wording.
- Preserve completed tasks.
- Name Ben as query owner and leave outcome open.

Add a complication: A short note says 'replace shrub next visit.'

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Confirming the booked grounds work

Editing example: Today's booking covers the front lawn and path; hedge shaping needs a separate review.

Specific tasks prevent a broad description from becoming an unintended promise.

Check 1: B - additional

A: The work order excludes it.

B: Correct. The hedge adds to the listed work.

C: It differs from mowing and leaf clearance.

D: It has not been completed.

Check 2: C - according to

A: 'Except' does not express dependence on a schedule.

B: 'Despite' suggests contradiction rather than following the schedule.

C: Correct. 'According to' links tasks to the schedule.

D: 'Instead of' would replace the schedule.

Model response: Today's work order covers the front lawn and leaf clearance from the path. Rear-hedge shaping isn't included in this visit. Is that an additional request you would like the office to review? I'll keep the new hedge request separate from the booked work so we don't imply that its price or timing has already been agreed.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Clarifying access and property limits

Editing example: The plan ends at the fence; the extra strip needs confirmation before inclusion.

The response does not make an ownership judgment.

Check 1: A - limit

A: Correct. The fence marks the plan's agreed work limit.

B: An estimate does not identify this location boundary.

C: A schedule concerns timing rather than this area limit.

D: A finish standard describes the result, not property ownership.

Check 2: A - awaiting inclusion confirmation

A: Correct. Inclusion of the additional area is still unconfirmed.

B: Today's work order ends at the fence.

C: Today's limit does not decide every future booking.

D: No agreement makes the strip part of recurring work.

Model response: The current work plan ends at the rear fence. I understand you believe the strip beyond it belongs to you, but that boundary hasn't been confirmed for this job. We can continue with the agreed area and refer the additional strip to the office. I can't extend today's work on the basis of 'probably.'

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Clarifying appearance and plant requests

Editing example: Do you mean the rosemary by the left bed, rather than the magnolia by the door?

Explicit location and identity avoid an ambiguous gesture.

Check 1: C - clarifying

A: The adjective does not fit here.

B: The past form does not follow 'for' this way.

C: Correct. 'For clarifying' describes the helpful action.

D: 'For' needs a suitable noun or gerund; 'clarity which' does not fit.

Check 2: D - preference

A: No pruning method has been selected or agreed.

B: Clarifying a request does not itself authorize the work.

C: No plant-health diagnosis was established by this clarification.

D: Correct. The discussion clarified the customer's desired appearance.

Model response: When you say 'the tall one,' do you mean the rosemary beside the left flower bed or the specimen magnolia near the door? Please identify the plant and describe the appearance you want. I can relay that request to the lead for review; identifying the plant doesn't by itself confirm a suitable pruning method or booking.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Explaining a weather-related change

Editing example: Thursday is proposed; the office still needs to confirm crew availability.

The revision prevents a suggestion from becoming a guarantee.

Check 1: D - provisional

A: Thursday has not been described as canceled.

B: No confirmed Thursday appointment is overdue.

C: The visit has not occurred.

D: Correct. It is proposed but unconfirmed.

Check 2: D - update

A: No inspection appointment was booked for Wednesday noon.

B: No crew arrival was promised for Wednesday noon.

C: No work completion was promised for Wednesday noon.

D: Correct. Wednesday noon is the requested communication deadline.

Model response: The lead has paused today's outdoor work because of the site conditions after rain. Thursday is a provisional date, not a confirmed replacement visit. I understand your event is Friday. I'll pass that deadline to the office and request an update by Wednesday noon, without promising that all work can be completed before the event.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Reporting site observations without diagnosis

Editing example: Water is pooled by the east bed; the cause has not been checked.

The statement stays within observed facts.

Check 1: A - a site observation

A: Correct. Visible pooling is an observation, not a verified cause.

B: The worker has not established a pipe failure.

C: No irrigation repair has been proposed and approved here.

D: The worker has not checked the irrigation system.

Check 2: A - the neighbor's reported experience

A: Correct. The account is attributed to its actual source.

B: The worker has not independently verified that history.

C: The neighbor's report does not establish an irrigation fault.

D: No repair instruction follows merely from that report.

Model response: At 09:15 I noticed standing water beside the east bed near zone three. I haven't checked the irrigation system, so I can't say a pipe is broken or identify the cause. I'll report the location and time to the grounds lead and ask for a review. The observation is confirmed; the explanation is not.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Checking materials and requested quantities

Editing example: Six natural-brown bags arrived against eight dark bags ordered.

The wording names both differences.

Check 1: A - material description

A: Correct. Natural brown differs from the agreed dark material description.

B: Delivery count repeats the already identified quantity difference.

C: Bag total describes quantity rather than the material mismatch.

D: Package number repeats the quantity issue rather than explaining the sample difference.

Check 2: B - establish

A: Mentioning does not mean verifying.

B: Correct. 'Establish' means demonstrate or confirm.

C: Preference does not prove sufficiency.

D: Requesting is not demonstrating adequacy.

Model response: The job lists eight bags of dark mulch for the front beds. Six bags arrived, and their label says natural brown. We have both a quantity difference and a material-description difference. Could the office check those against the approved sample and supplier order before we describe this delivery as matching the job?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Responding to finish and cleanup concerns

Editing example: The front-step area still has clippings; that part of the listed cleanup was missed.

The response acknowledges the customer's supported observation.

Check 1: B - included

A: The front steps were included, not excluded from cleanup.

B: Correct. It was part of the agreed task.

C: It directly concerns the booked cleanup.

D: It was listed, not merely proposed.

Check 2: C - separate

A: No duplicate request is established.

B: The customer has not withdrawn it.

C: Correct. It is distinct from correcting the missed front area.

D: It has not been done.

Model response: You're right that clippings remain beside the front steps, which are part of today's listed path cleanup. I'm sorry that area was missed. I'll ask the lead to arrange completion of that specific cleanup and confirm the plan with you. The rear patio is a separate request, so let's keep it distinct from this missed task.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Handing over unfinished grounds work

Editing example: The front path is complete; the rear-bed review and callback remain outstanding.

The distinction prevents unfinished work being lost.

Check 1: D - postponed

A: The review was postponed; no diagnosis was made.

B: The work was not replaced.

C: The review has not finished.

D: Correct. Deferred means postponed, not canceled or completed.

Check 2: A - contact

A: Correct. The callback arranges communication, not a site visit.

B: A callback does not establish completed site work.

C: A callback alone does not approve a grounds task.

D: A site assessment has not been booked here.

Model response: The front-path leaf clearance at Pine Court is complete. The rear-bed review remains deferred; no planting or diagnosis was carried out there. Ava, the customer requests a callback before Friday about that bed. Please take the scheduling follow-up and confirm the callback arrangement. The request should not be recorded as a booked return visit yet.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All properties, people, quantities, incidents, and service arrangements are fictional language practice, not horticultural, pesticide, equipment, irrigation, tree-work, safety, or property-law training. Do not infer plant treatments, application rates, pruning methods, site safety, or legal boundaries from these examples. Refer technical suitability, hazardous conditions, property questions, prices, and job changes to the responsible qualified people.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Grounds Maintenance Workers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/building-and-grounds-cleaning/grounds-maintenance-workers.htm>

OSHA: Landscape and Horticultural Services Overview

<https://www.osha.gov/landscaping>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Landscaping and Grounds English

Professional audience: Landscape crew members, groundskeepers, lawn-service workers, and grounds assistants

Scope: All properties, people, quantities, incidents, and service arrangements are fictional language practice, not horticultural, pesticide, equipment, irrigation, tree-work, safety, or property-law training. Do not infer plant treatments, application rates, pruning methods, site safety, or legal boundaries from these examples. Refer technical suitability, hazardous conditions, property questions, prices, and job changes to the responsible qualified people.

Lesson 01: Confirming the booked grounds work

Original fictional case: Oak Court's work order includes front-lawn mowing and path leaf clearance. Resident asks for rear-hedge shaping. Hedges are excluded from today's booking; office can review a separate request, with no price or date confirmed.

Language workshop: Name what the visit includes

Communication goal: Clarify an extra task without dismissing the customer's request.

Language guidance: A recurring service does not automatically include every grounds task on every visit.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): Today's work order includes _____. / _____ is outside this visit's listed work. / Would you like the office to review _____ separately?

Vocabulary: work order: The job record stating the grounds work requested or agreed for a visit. / service

area: The specified part of a property included in a grounds job. / exclusion: A task or location expressly left outside the agreed work. / recurring visit: A grounds-service appointment that repeats on an agreed schedule.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Resident: you assumed a regular grounds visit included the hedge; ask for a separate review.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: The resident asks whether requesting the extra task guarantees it today. Distinguish request from booking.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Today's work order covers the front lawn and leaf clearance from the path. Rear-hedge shaping isn't included in this visit. Is that an additional request you would like the office to review? I'll keep the new hedge request separate from the booked work so we don't imply that its price or timing has already been agreed.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT